

through a number of tests. Tickle also charges \$14.95 a month for a premium test subscription which gives unlimited access to every personalized report on the Tickle site. The site also contains a number of ice-breaking type e-mails that members can send to one another, as well as a number of fun tests. It also allows people to communicate directly to one another via a Tickle instant messenger.

Tribe (www.tribe.net)

Tribe, which began in January 2003, is another SNS in beta testing that aims to keep its services to members free of charge by deriving revenue from job postings and featured listings. While Tribe is primarily used for social purposes, for example if someone moves to a new area and they are looking for information on accommodation or restaurants or concerts, the site does include professional elements such as job postings. As well as each user having a defined set of friends, Tribe contains many categories of communities where each community is termed a tribe, and a message forum and events listing is associated with that tribe. Messages from forums are also made available in RSS format for use in desktop news aggregating applications.

1.3 SNS Motivations

People are making full use of these social networking sites for personal and professional use, communications, new business developments and contacts, dating and meeting offline without the three dimensional interpersonal communication. They make use of an easy and efficient way to build and manage their offline social networks online. Communities can be better informed more quickly through online social networking, and become more engaged and involved with one another in an era when social capital is on the decline. The development of this new social and business infrastructure has motivated more people to join up with a specific aim in mind. Some sites like Friendster, orkut and Ryze use the photos for browsing (Friendster uses the term “gallery” for viewing individuals). People are curious and voyeuristic, they tend to browse through these photos searching for people they find